

01-13-2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r_VpZFTdUnI
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Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees & Board of Finance Meeting Report

Meeting Date: January 13, 2026 (Implied from context of annual organization and FY 2025 financial wrap-up)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees was called to order by the presiding officer, welcoming attendees back after a significant gap in meetings.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heer, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Low.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as President Williams (referred to as Mr. Williams).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly detailed in the opening procedural window, but routine administrative items and the consent agenda were handled.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:10:14 Consent Agenda & Staff Introductions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board welcomed two new educators joining Southside Middle School: Ashley Guard (Master Teacher) and Jason Holly (Social Studies Teacher). Both introduced themselves and shared their backgrounds in education and ties to Randolph County. Additionally, the board recognized donors to the Panther Pantry and a donation from Jane Bots to the basketball team.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:16:49 2027<U+2013>2028 School Calendar**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Grim presented the proposed 2027<U+2013>2028 school calendar. The calendar features 180 student days, 185 teacher days, a 5-day fall break (shifted a week later to align with county schools and count day on Friday, October 1st), a two-week winter break, a five-week [sic: five-day] spring break, and early releases. Makeup days will occur after Memorial Day, utilizing up to three asynchronous e-learning days prior.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:23:56 FY 2025 Financial Report & Year-End Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the actual financial results for the 2025 calendar year. Highlights included:
 - Enrollment down by only 14 students from October 2024 (totaling 4,894 students).
 - State basic grant revenue up by nearly \$600,000.
 - All-funds total cash balance at \$40.6 million (the highest in eight years, bolstered by \$9 million in bond proceeds received in November).
 - Outstanding state common school loan reduced from \$12 million (originating in 2019) down to \$5.7 million, with annual payments of over \$2.2 million.

- Education fund balance ending at \$14.3 million (down slightly due to planned transfers to the rainy day and operations funds).
 - Total payroll at \$36.5 million, up a modest 2.1%.
 - Board members discussed future fiscal cliffs driven by state legislative changes (such as Senate Bill 1) and the necessity of continued fiscal stewardship, building-level cost evaluations, and upcoming consultations with Baker Tilly.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **04:05:05 Education Fund to Operations Fund Transfer Resolution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An annual resolution authorizing the transfer of funds from the Education Fund to the Operations Fund for calendar year 2026, up to the statutory cap of 15% of total Education Fund revenue, eliminating the need for monthly board approvals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

Board of Finance Meeting Actions

- **00:44:50 Reorganization & Annual Financial Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Board Members
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Board of Trustees temporarily recessed to convene as the Board of Finance for its required annual meeting.
 - **Officers Appointed:** Mr. Low was appointed President of the Board of Finance; Mr. Irvin was appointed Secretary.
 - **Financial Reports Received:** Mr. Derome presented the annual investment report (noting over \$419,000 in interest earned for 2025), long-term debt updates (total long-term debt at \$24.8 million following \$8.7 million in retirements), common school loan paydown status, and rainy day fund balances (\$3.1 million). The board also reviewed links to State Board of Finance fiscal health indicators and discussed interactions with the Distressed Unit Appeals Board (DUAB).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Board of Finance meeting adjourned by voice vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: The transcript indicates there were no public signups for participation during the open public comment period.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds highlighted upcoming MLK weekend events, including the Delaware County MLK Citizenship Award program hosted at Central on Saturday, and the Ball State MLK kickoff breakfast on Monday recognizing top academic seniors.
 - Recognition of the North Side Choir for being selected to perform at the Indiana Music Educators Association (IMEA) Conference in Fort Wayne [00:07:17](#).
 - Acknowledgment of school athletic achievements, including the girls wrestling sectional champion and state qualifier Lierra Rollins, the boys swim team winning back-to-back conference championships, and board appreciation month honors [00:08:06](#).
 - **Adjournment:** The regular meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following closing remarks and lighthearted exchanges regarding family interns [\[01:01:09\]](#).
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